KCC CODE CLUB · GAME MAKERS

Showcase Run Sheet

For families, after week eight

The showcase is the finish line the whole course is built towards. It's its own event, after week eight — it doesn't fit inside a sixty-minute class. It runs forty-five minutes to an hour depending on headcount, and takes about two hours of preparation, most of which happens the week before.

The week before

- [ ] Remind parents of the date, time and place. It was in the first letter, but it's a separate event from the last class, so say so plainly or some will just turn up at pickup
- [ ] Print certificates **with names already filled in**. Not on the day
- [ ] Check the photo permission list and note which children must not be photographed
- [ ] Confirm who's bringing snacks
- [ ] Confirm the projector and the presenting laptop

On the day

- [ ] Presenting laptop set up and tested with the projector
- [ ] **Every student's project on the USB stick as an** `.sb3` — done in the last ten minutes of week eight. If anyone's is missing, download it from the club studio now
- [ ] **Scratch Desktop open and working** on the presenting laptop — this is your wi-fi insurance
- [ ] Club Scratch studio open in a tab with every project added
- [ ] Chairs out for families before they arrive
- [ ] Snacks and cups somewhere out of reach until the right moment
- [ ] Certificates in presentation order

Running order

Work out your finish time before you set the invitation time. Demos are the whole event and they scale linearly with headcount:

Students	Demos at 2 min each	Plus fixed overhead	Showcase needs
10	20 min	17 min	**~40 min**
12	24 min	17 min	**~45 min**
16	32 min	17 min	**~50 min**
20	40 min	17 min	**~1 hour**

The fixed overhead is welcome (2), certificates (3), open play (10) and wrap-up (2).

This does not fit inside a sixty-minute class at any class size, and week eight's own hour is needed for finishing the games anyway. So the showcase is a separate event: a second hour straight after week eight if the venue will give you one, or a slot at the next KCC gathering, where the audience will be bigger. Book it when you book the term. Parents are coming specially; they will not mind, and squeezing it is how you end up cutting the demos, which are the only reason anyone is in the room.

Time	What	Who
−0:15	Set up — chairs out, projector up, Scratch Desktop tested, snacks out	Volunteers
0:00	Families arrive and settle	—
+0:02	Welcome — **two minutes maximum**	Lead volunteer
+0:04	Student demos, 2 minutes each	Each student
—	Certificates	Lead volunteer
—	Open play — parents try the games	Everyone
—	Wrap up, thank yous, what's next	Lead volunteer

Keep the welcome short. The parents did not come to hear an adult talk. If you're running to a hard finish, cut the welcome to sixty seconds, not the demos.

If you have more than about 14 students

Two options, in order of preference:

1. **Run demos in two parallel corners**, each hosted by a volunteer, then bring everyone back together for certificates. Halves the running time, and the smaller audience actually suits the shyer children better.
2. **Cut demos to 90 seconds** and drop the play-through to fifteen seconds. Keep the hardest-bug question — that's the part worth protecting.

The welcome — what to actually say

Two minutes, roughly this:

> Thank you all for coming. Eight weeks ago none of these kids had written a line of code. Today every one of them has built a working game from an empty screen — they designed it, they broke it, and they worked out how to fix it themselves. That last part is the bit we're proudest of.
>
> Each of them is going to show you what they made for a couple of minutes. Ask them how it works — they can tell you, and they'll enjoy it.
>
> [Thank the volunteers by name. Thank the venue. Mention next term if there is one.]

Then get out of the way.

The student demo — two minutes each

Each child, on the projector:

1. **What their game is**, in one sentence.

2. **Play it for thirty seconds.** Let a parent have a go if there's time.
3. **The hardest bug they fixed, and how they found it.**

Point three is the one that matters. Prompt them if they freeze — *"what was the thing that took you longest to work out?"* — and let them tell the story. It turns a demo into an achievement, and it's what the parents will actually remember.

Helping the reluctant ones

Some children will say they don't want to present. Almost always this is nerves, not unwillingness. What works:

- Offer to stand next to them and ask the three questions while they drive the mouse.
- Offer to let them go first, before the anticipation builds, or last, once they've seen it's fine.
- Let them present in a pair with a friend.

What doesn't work is letting them skip it. Every child should have their family see something they made. Find the version of it they can manage.

Certificates

Name, the club, the term, and something specific if you can manage it — "Best Boss Battle", "Most Determined Debugger", "Most Original Idea". A specific line is worth ten generic ones, and it takes five minutes to write twelve of them the night before.

Everyone gets one. This is not a competition.

Open play

Ten minutes where parents wander and children explain their games. This is the best part of the evening and it runs itself; your only job is not to interrupt it.

Use the time to talk to parents — you'll learn more about how the term went in these ten minutes than from any feedback form.

When the wi-fi dies

It will pick tonight. This is why the USB stick exists.

1. Open Scratch Desktop on the presenting laptop.
2. Open the student's `.sb3` from the stick.
3. Carry on. Nobody in the room needs to know.

Have this tested before the parents arrive, not discovered during the third demo.

Afterwards

- [ ] Message every parent within two days with the studio link so they can show grandparents
- [ ] Ask two questions: **what did your child enjoy most**, and **would they come back?**
- [ ] Close the term's money off with the treasurer — who paid, who was waived

- [ ] Sit down with the other volunteer and write down what went wrong while it's fresh. Twenty minutes now saves hours next term
- [ ] Note which students are ready for the Python track, and tell their parents